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## Connections & API Integrations Required

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Every external service DropKast depends on, ranked by **how soon you need it**.

Pricing is current as of April 2026. Confirm before signing — contracts change.

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# Tier 0: Need to ship a real product (do these next 2 weeks)

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These four are non-negotiable. Without them DropKast is a great UI on top of fake data. With them, it's a real distro.

## 1. Anthropic (Claude) — AI brain

- **What it powers:** Chat assistant with tool use, A&R critique, campaign strategy.
- **Where to get:** <https://console.anthropic.com/settings/keys>
- **Setup time:** 10 minutes (sign up, generate key, paste in Vercel env).
- **Cost:** Pay-as-you-go. ~\$0.02–0.05 per 10-message session with prompt caching. See [BUDGET\\_PLAN.md](#) for projections.
- **Status:** Code wired, just add [ANTHROPIC\\_API\\_KEY](#) env var.

## 2. Supabase — Auth + Postgres + Storage

- **What it powers:** Real user accounts, persistent database (replaces in-memory [db](#)), uploaded file storage (replaces Cloudinary if desired).
- **Where to get:** <https://supabase.com> — sign up, create project. You'll get a URL, anon key, and service role key.
- **Setup time:** 1 hour for project setup + Drizzle migration push.
- **Cost:** Pro plan \$25/month (8 GB database, 100 GB storage, 100K MAU). Free tier covers up to 500 MB DB / 50K MAU for testing.
- **Status:** Drizzle schema already written ([db/schema.ts](#)); just create the project and set [DATABASE\\_URL](#) + [VITE\\_SUPABASE\\_URL](#) + [VITE\\_SUPABASE\\_ANON\\_KEY](#).

## 3. RouteNote (or SonoSuite) — Real DSP delivery

- **What it powers:** The actual distribution to Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, Tidal, etc. Without this the "deliver" step is a [setTimeout](#) that pretends.
- **Where to get:** RouteNote partner program <https://routenote.com> (B2B); SonoSuite <https://sonosuite.com> (white-label). Both require sales contact + DDEX

approval.

- **Setup time:** 2–6 weeks (legal + DDEX onboarding).
- **Cost (RouteNote):**
  - Free tier: keep 90% of royalties (RouteNote takes 10%). \$0/release.
  - Premium: 10/*single*, 20/EP, 30/*album*, 9.99/yr renewal. Artist keeps 100%.
  - Partner API: contact for B2B rates.
- **Cost (SonoSuite):** Custom pricing — contact sales. Typical white-label setup runs 1K–5K/month base + per-release fees.
- **Recommendation:** Start with RouteNote API (cheaper to validate). Move to SonoSuite if you outgrow it.
- **Alternative:** Build DDEX delivery direct to each DSP. ~6 months of engineering. Not recommended for v1.
- **Status:** Need partnership; code ready to plug in (`api/_app.ts:processRelease`).

## 4. Stripe Connect — Royalty splits payouts

- **What it powers:** Pays artists, producers, featured artists, and influencers from the splits page automatically. Without this, splits get recorded but nobody gets paid.
- **Where to get:** <https://dashboard.stripe.com> — enable Connect platform.
- **Setup time:** 2–3 days. Express accounts are the fastest onboarding path.
- **Cost:**
  - Standard payment processing: 2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction (US).
  - Express/Custom Connect accounts: \$2/month per active account.
  - Payouts: 0.25% + 0.25% per payout (capped at 25).
  - Instant payouts (optional): 1% of payout.
- **Status:** Schema has `stripeAccountId` field on users + `splits` table. Need to wire onboarding flow + `transfer.paid` webhook.

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● **Tier 1: Need before mass launch  
(next 4–8 weeks)**

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## 5. RIAA — ISRC registrant code

- **What it powers:** Real ISRC codes that DSPs accept (current code uses a placeholder `DKT` registrant).
- **Where to get:** <https://usisrc.org> (US ISRC Agency / RIAA).
- **Setup time:** 1–3 weeks.
- **Cost:** ~\$95 one-time admin fee for a registrant prefix that lets you mint unlimited ISRCs yourself.
- **Status:** Code already mints valid-format ISRCs; just set `ISRC_REGISTRANT=YOURPREFIX` env var.

## 6. GS1 US — UPC company prefix

- **What it powers:** Real UPC barcodes for releases. Required for retailers + some streaming platforms.
- **Where to get:** <https://www.gs1us.org>
- **Setup time:** 1–2 weeks.
- **Cost:**
  - Initial fee: ~\$250 for 10–100,000 codes (depends on annual revenue).
  - Annual renewal: ~\$50–2,100 depending on tier.
- **Status:** Code mints valid UPC-A with mod-10 check digits; just set `UPC_COMPANY_PREFIX=YOURPREFIX`.

## 7. Cloudinary OR Cloudflare R2 — Audio + artwork storage/CDN

- **What it powers:** Where uploaded audio masters and cover art actually live. Multer in-memory works for demo; not for production.
- **Recommendation:** **Cloudflare R2** — same price as S3 with **zero egress fees** (huge for audio CDN). Or stay with Cloudinary if you want image transformations baked in.
- **Cost (R2):**  $0.015/\text{GB} - \text{monthstorage} + 0/\text{GB egress}$  (free).
- **Cost (Cloudinary):** Free tier = 25GB; paid plans from \$89/month.
- **Setup time:** 4 hours.
- **Status:** Cloudinary already wired with optional fallback. R2 needs an adapter swap.

## 8. Sentry — Error tracking

- **What it powers:** Catches frontend + backend exceptions in production before users tweet about them.
- **Where to get:** <https://sentry.io>
- **Setup time:** 30 minutes.
- **Cost:** Free tier (5K errors/month). Team plan *26/month for 50K errors*. Business 80/month.
- **Status:** Not wired. Add [@sentry/react](#) + [@sentry/node](#).

## 9. Cloudflare — DDoS / WAF / DNS

- **What it powers:** Free DDoS protection, WAF (rate limit abuse, block bots), CDN for static assets, DNS.
- **Where to get:** <https://dash.cloudflare.com> — point your domain at Cloudflare.
- **Setup time:** 1 hour.
- **Cost:** Free for the basics. Business plan \$250/month for SOC2 reports + advanced WAF.
- **Status:** Not configured. Vercel handles DDoS in front of you, but Cloudflare in front of Vercel adds belt-and-braces.

## 10. PostHog — Product analytics

- **What it powers:** Track signup, upload, deliver, payout funnels. Way more useful than Google Analytics for a SaaS.
- **Where to get:** <https://posthog.com>
- **Setup time:** 30 minutes.
- **Cost:** Free up to 1M events/month. Then \$0.00031/event.
- **Status:** Not wired.

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## Tier 2: Nice-to-have (next 2–3 months)

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## 11. TikTok / Meta Graph API — Influencer post verification

- **What it powers:** When an influencer submits a post URL claiming "I posted your campaign," the API confirms the audio in their video matches the release. Without it, you have to trust them or manually verify.
- **Where to get:**
  - TikTok: <https://developers.tiktok.com> — apply for Marketing API access.
  - Meta: <https://developers.facebook.com> — apply for Instagram Graph API + Reels access.
- **Setup time:** 4–8 weeks each (platform review).
- **Cost:** Free APIs, but app-review approval can take a month.
- **Status:** Code-side adapter not built; verification button is a stub.

## 12. SoundExchange — Neighbouring rights royalties

- **What it powers:** Collects performance royalties from US digital radio + non-interactive streaming (Pandora, SiriusXM). Many artists don't even know this revenue exists.
- **Where to get:** <https://www.soundexchange.com> — register as a sound recording owner.
- **Setup time:** 2 weeks (verification).
- **Cost:** Free to register. They take ~5–10% of collected royalties.

## 13. ASCAP / BMI / SESAC — PRO (publishing royalties)

- **What it powers:** Performance royalties on the COMPOSITION (lyrics + melody). Different from master royalties.
- **Where to get:** Pick one PRO. ASCAP is the most artist-friendly.
- **Setup time:** 2–4 weeks.
- **Cost:** ASCAP — *50one – timeforwriter*, 50 for publisher.

## 14. MLC (Mechanical Licensing Collective) — Mechanical royalties

- **What it powers:** Mechanical royalties on US streaming + downloads.

- **Where to get:** <https://www.themlc.com>
- **Setup time:** 1 week.
- **Cost:** Free to register. They take a small admin fee.

## 15. ElevenLabs / OpenAI TTS — Optional voice for AI assistant

- **What it powers:** Read the AI assistant's responses out loud for hands-free use.
- **Where to get:** <https://elevenlabs.io> (best voice quality), <https://platform.openai.com/audio> (cheaper).
- **Cost:** ElevenLabs Pro *99/month for 100K characters*. OpenAI TTS *15/1M* characters.
- **Status:** Not wired.

## Tier 3: AI Generation (image + video, when premium tier ships)

These are wired in the catalog but adapters need building when you're ready.

### Image

| Provider                                                                | Use case                                             | Cost                                                                      | Setup                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Flux (Black Forest Labs)</b> via <a href="https://fal.ai">fal.ai</a> | Cover art (Schnell tier<br>\$0.003/img on Replicate) | <a href="https://fal.ai/dashboard/keys">https://fal.ai/dashboard/keys</a> | 1 hour                                                                |
| <b>Google Nano Banana 2</b>                                             | Premium covers                                       | Free 50/day, \$0.067/img after                                            | <a href="https://aistudio.google.com">https://aistudio.google.com</a> |
| <b>Ideogram</b>                                                         | Lyric cards,                                         | \$0.02–0.05/img                                                           | <a href="https://ideogram.ai/api">https://ideogram.ai/api</a>         |

| Provider                                                            | Use case                 | Cost            | Setup                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                     | posters<br>with text     |                 |                                                                       |
| <b>OpenAI</b><br><b>DALL-E 3</b><br><b>/ gpt-</b><br><b>image-1</b> | Stylized<br>illustration | \$0.04–0.12/img | <a href="https://platform.openai.com">https://platform.openai.com</a> |

## Video

| Provider                          | Use case                                                   | Cost                 | Setup                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kling 3.0</b>                  | Music videos (cheapest<br>per sec, 66 free<br>credits/day) | \$0.029/sec          | <a href="https://klingai.com">https://klingai.com</a>                 |
| <b>Pika 2.0</b>                   | Short-form / Reels (free<br>80 credits/mo)                 | Standard<br>\$10/mo  | <a href="https://pika.art">https://pika.art</a>                       |
| <b>Veo 3.1</b><br><b>(Google)</b> | Premium cinematic                                          | ~\$0.40–<br>0.50/sec | <a href="https://aistudio.google.com">https://aistudio.google.com</a> |
| <b>Runway</b><br><b>Gen-4</b>     | Director-grade control                                     | \$12/mo+             | <a href="https://app.runwayml.com">https://app.runwayml.com</a>       |

## Already in place (just need keys)

These have working code adapters; you only need to add the env var to use them.

| Variable                      | Provider   | Why use it                                    | Free tier?             |
|-------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <code>NVIDIA_API_KEY</code>   | NVIDIA NIM | Free chat fallback when<br>Claude budget hits | ✅ 40 RPM<br>indefinite |
| <code>GROQ_API_KEY</code>     | Groq       | Free chat — fastest<br>inference              | ✅ 1M<br>tokens/day     |
| <code>CEREBRAS_API_KEY</code> | Cerebras   | Free chat — highest<br>daily cap              | ✅ 1M<br>tokens/day, 8K |



| Variable                        | Provider   | Why use it                     | Free tier?        |
|---------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
|                                 |            |                                | ctx               |
| <code>OPENROUTER_API_KEY</code> | OpenRouter | Free Llama 4 / Qwen / DeepSeek | ✅ 50 req/day free |

## Engineering integrations (no cost, just dev time)

These are software-only — no external account needed but they take engineering effort.

- **Loudness normalization** for audio uploads (LUFS analysis with `web-audio-api` or server-side `ffmpeg`). 1 day.
- **HLS/DASH streaming** for in-app track previews. 2–3 days.
- **Webhook handler hardening** — verify Stripe + RouteNote signatures. 1 day.
- **Audit logs table + middleware** for admin actions. 1 day.
- **Rate limiting** on `/api/ai/*` and `/api/auth/*` with Upstash Ratelimit. 4 hours.
- **GDPR data export + delete** endpoints. 1 day.
- **DMCA takedown flow** — admin tool to mark releases as `taken_down` with reason logging. 1 day.

## TL;DR: minimum to launch a paid product

If you can get these 5 things, you can charge artists money:

1. ✅ **Anthropic key** — AI features.
2. ✅ **Supabase project** — real auth + database.
3. ✅ **RouteNote partnership** — actual delivery to DSPs.
4. ✅ **Stripe Connect** — splits payouts.
5. ✅ **RIAA + GS1 codes** — legitimate ISRC/UPC.

Estimated time to full v1: **6–8 weeks** assuming nobody else's onboarding bottlenecks you.

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# Sources

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Pricing data current as of April 2026:

- [RouteNote Pricing](#)
- [Vercel Pricing](#)
- [Supabase Pricing](#)
- [Stripe Connect Pricing](#)
- [Cloudflare Stream Pricing](#)
- [US ISRC Agency / RIAA](#)
- [GS1 US Pricing](#)
- [DDEX Standard](#)
- [Anthropic API Pricing](#)